❌ No in-app payments
❌ No commissions
✅ Vendor & customer matching
✅ Listings, chats, contact, and order intent
✅ Platform earns via registration/subscription fees

This framing protects you legally and technically.

2. Core Product Model (Very Important)
Roles
You will have 2 main user roles:
Vendors (Sellers)
Customers (Buyers)

Super Admin:
Admin (Platform owner)

3. MVP Feature Set (Keep It Simple & Profitable)
A. Vendor Side (Seller App Features)
Vendors should be able to:
Sign up & pay registration fee

Create a store profile:
Business name
Location
Contact details
WhatsApp / phone

Add products:
Product name
Price (display only)
Images
Description
Manage product availability
Receive customer inquiries
Chat or receive direct contact from customers
Renew subscription (monthly / yearly)

No payment handling = less compliance & faster launch

B. Customer Side (Buyer App Features)
Customers should be able to:
Sign up / browse without signup (optional)

Search products by:
Category
Location
Price
View vendor profiles

Click:
"Contact Seller"
"Chat on WhatsApp"
"Call Vendor"
Save vendors/products

Send inquiry messages
Orders and payments happen offline or externally.

C. Admin Panel (Critical for Control)
You MUST include this.
Admin can:
Approve or reject vendors
Manage vendor subscriptions
Feature vendors (paid boost later)
Moderate content
View analytics (users, vendors, listings)

4. Monetization Model (Aligned with Client's Request)
Since no commission is charged:
Primary Revenue
Vendor registration fee
Vendor subscription plans
Basic (limited listings)
Premium (more listings + featured placement)
Optional Add-ons (Future)
Featured vendor badge
Sponsored listings
Location-based promotion

This keeps the platform sustainable.

5. Legal & Trust Considerations (Do NOT Skip)
Because payments happen outside the app:
You MUST:

Add Terms & Disclaimer
Platform is not responsible for transactions
No liability for disputes

Clear messaging:
"This platform connects buyers and sellers. Payments and deliveries are handled directly."

This protects:
The client
Your company
App store approvals

6. Tech Stack Recommendation (Fast, Clean, Scalable)
App
Flutter (iOS + Android from one codebase)
OR React Native if your team prefers JS

Backend
Firebase or Supabase
Auth (vendors/customers)
Database (products, profiles)
Storage (images)

Admin dashboard:
Next.js / React + Firebase Admin SDK
Payments (Registration Only)

Stripe / Paystack / Flutterwave
(Only for vendor signup & subscriptions)

No marketplace payment compliance needed.

7. UX Philosophy (Why This Will Work)
The app should feel like:
Instagram Marketplace
Jiji / Facebook Marketplace
Alibaba supplier discovery

3-click rule:
Customer should reach a seller in ≤ 3 taps.
8. Suggested Build Phases (Smart Delivery)
Phase 1 – MVP (XXX weeks)
Vendor registration + fee
Product listings
Customer browsing
Contact seller
Admin panel

Phase 2 – Growth
Vendor subscription tiers
Featured vendors
In-app chat
Ratings & reviews

Phase 3 – Scale (Optional)
Escrow payments (if client later wants)
Logistics integrations
AI product recommendations